

China Pharma and Biotech

China Pharma & Biotech: ASCO 2026 Part 1 - meet the best Keytruda booster



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The first batch of ASCO abstracts were released this morning, and we round up the most anticipated NSCLC readouts in our coverage here.

Kelun-Biotech - Sac-TMT + pembro vs. pembro in 1L PD-L1+ patients (Ph3 OptiTROP-Lung05): despite low data maturity, we found them strongly positive. Median PFS not reached at median follow-up 10.5m vs. 5.7m, HR 0.35; OS not mature, HR 0.55. **1) Stretching the mPFS range.** How past trials fared in the same patient group: Keytruda mono 5-6m, AK112 mono 11m, Keytruda + chemo 8-11m, Keytruda + other TROP2 ADCs 9-13m. **Now sac-TMT is trending at 16m+ mPFS (approximated by 5.7m/0.35).** Also, an earlier Ph2 trial OptiTROP-Lung01 (sac-TMT + PD-L1) had reported mPFS 15.4m. **2) Early OS benefits shown by HR 0.55 is the best early trend we've seen so far.** **3) From subgroup analyses, the combo outperformed in PD-L1 1-49% vs. PD-L1 high, and did better in non-squamous patients than squamous - both are larger patient groups.**

If we're asking what could replace Keytruda ("I/O 2.0"), the jury is out. **If we're asking what could be the best Keytruda booster - Sac-TMT looks the most promising.** And a Keytruda booster should also work with I/O 2.0, whether there will be such a thing.

Innovent - IBI363 in 2L+ I/O-failed NSCLC (updates on the Ph1 trial): sample size limits the readthrough of absolute survival data, but 24% OS rates are encouraging. There are some adjustments to the mPFS and mOS numbers from ASCO 2025. Now the best mOS is 17.5m (low dosage) and 18.2m (3mg) for nsq and sq, respectively. In comparison, docetaxel typically gives 9-12m in OS. Due to low n (20-30 in each treatment group), we cannot read too much into the absolute numbers. The 24m OS% could be a better measure: 40-50% patients are still alive vs. typically 15-20% with docetaxel.

Innovent - IBI363 + chemo in 1L NSCLC: high ORR and Innovent joins ranks in I/O 2.0 hopefuls with newly announced H2H trial against Keytruda + chemo. The much anticipated 1L PoC study had only ORR to reveal at this point. Notably, a high to low dosing regimen (3 mg/kg IBI363 + PDC in cycle 1, followed by 1.5 mg/kg Q3W + PDC) gave an outstanding 81.8% ORR, the highest across all similar trials. Innovent also announced that as the second part of the PoC study, a randomized head-to-head study of 3→1.5 mg/kg IBI363+ chemo vs. pembro + chemo as first-line treatment for advanced NSCLC (all PD-L1 expression levels) is ongoing.

We think both Kelun-Biotech and Innovent present great buy opportunities. Out of the two, Kelun is closer to the finish line, while Innovent's ambition in 1L desperately awaits corroboration from partner Takeda - the start of global Ph3.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			21 May 2026		TTM	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
9926.HK (Akeso)	M	HKD	120.00	130.00	(0.7)%	CNY	(0.60)	(0.52)	0.70	(172.3)	(201.9)	149.1
ONC (BeOne)	O	USD	309.62	412.00	3.5%	USD	2.63	5.65	8.93	117.7	54.8	34.7
1093.HK (CSPC)	M	HKD	7.34	10.70	(27.0)%	HKD	0.37	0.52	0.56	17.3	12.3	11.4
3692.HK (Hansoh)	O	HKD	34.10	47.00	(7.5)%	CNY	0.93	1.01	1.10	31.8	29.3	26.9
1801.HK (Innovent)	O	HKD	82.55	120.00	6.5%	HKD	0.48	0.71	2.90	170.2	116.3	28.5
600276.CH (Hengrui)	O	CNY	51.45	71.00	(47.7)%	CNY	1.19	1.54	1.92	43.2	33.3	26.8
6990.HK (Kelun-Biotech)	O	HKD	453.60	526.00	(1.5)%	CNY	(1.66)	(2.75)	0.85	38.3	38.9	23.9
1177.HK (Sino BioPh)	M	HKD	5.28	7.90	(14.8)%	CNY	0.19	0.20	0.22	24.0	23.1	20.9
9688.HK (Zai Lab)	M	HKD	14.34	15.00	(83.2)%	USD	(0.16)	(0.15)	(0.09)	3.6	3.3	2.8
ASIAx			1,924.46									
SPX			7,445.72									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

6990.HK, 9688.HK valuation is EV/Sales (x); 9926.HK, 1093.HK, 1177.HK base year is 2024;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DETAILS

Quick access to all abstracts at ASCO: [Program guide-2026 ASCO Annual Meeting](#)

1L PD-L1 POSITIVE NSCLC

Abstract 8506, OptiTROP-Lung05: [Session Detail for Lung Cancer—Non-Small Cell Metastatic](#)

EXHIBIT 1: In 1L PD-L1 positive NSCLC setting, sac-TMT + pembrolizumab delivered 70.2% of ORR, with PFS HR at 0.35 and OS HR at 0.55, competitive across groups

	PD-1/L1 monotherapy		PD-1 + chemo			IO + Anti-angiogenic		TROP2 ADC + PD-1					
	Pembrolizumab		Pembrolizumab + chemo			Ivonescimab		Sac-TMT		Trodelvy		Dato-DXd	
Sponsor	Merck		Merck	Merck		Akeso / Summit		Kelun-Biotech		Gilead		DS / AZ	
Trial	KEYNOTE-042 (NCT02220894)		KEYNOTE-407 (sq-NSCLC)	KEYNOTE-189 (nsq-NSCLC)		HARMONI-2 (NCT05499390)		OptiTROP-Lung05		EVOKE-02 (NCT05186974)		TROPION-Lung02	
Target modality	PD-1		PD-1	PD-1		PD-1/VEGF		PD-1 + TROP2 ADC		PD-1 + TROP2 ADC		PD-1 + TROP2 ADC	
PD-L1 expression	PD-L1 TPS ≥1%		PD-L1 TPS ≥1%	TPS 1-49% TPS ≥ 50%		PD-L1 TPS ≥1%		PD-L1 TPS ≥1%		TPS 1-49% TPS ≥ 50% TPS < 50% TPS ≥ 50%			
Intervention (arm)	Pembrolizumab	Chemo	Pembrolizumab + chemo		Pembrolizumab+chemo	Ivonescimab	Pembrolizumab	Sac-TMT + pembrolizumab	Pembrolizumab	Trodelvy + pembrolizumab		Dato-DXd + pembrolizumab	
n	637	637	176		186 202	198	200	208	205	33	30	30	5
ORR%	27.3%	26.7%	59.1%		49.2% 62.1%	50%	39%	70.2%	42.0%	36.4%	66.7%	50%	100%
mPFS	5.6	6.8	8.0		9.2 11.1	11.1	5.8	NR at mFU 10.5m	5.7	9.1	13.1	11.1	> 8.3, NE
PFS HR	1.05					0.51		0.35 (95% CI 0.26 - 0.47)					
mOS	16.4	12.1	18.9		21.8 > 20.4			Not mature				> 19.2, NE > 12.6, NE	
OS HR	0.79					0.777		0.55 (95% CI 0.36 - 0.85)					
Safety	G≥3 TRAE: 18%	G≥3 TRAE: 41%	G≥3 TRAE: 56.5% (all patients)		G≥3 AE: 71.9% (all patients)	G≥3 TRAE: 29.4%	G≥3 TRAE: 15.6%	G≥3 TEAE: 55.3%	G≥3 TEAE: 31.4%	G≥3 TEAE: 76.1%		G≥3 TRAE: 40.5%	

Source: IASLC, WCLC, J Clin Oncol, ASCO, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: In PFS HR subgroup analysis, sac-TMT + pembrolizumab achieves more significant hazard ratios than HARMONI-2, esp. in non-squamous and TPS 1-49% subgroups

Subgroup analysis: PFS HR	PD-L1 expression		Histology	
	TPS 1-49%	TPS ≥ 50%	Squamous	Non-squamous
HARMONI-2 (ivonescimab vs pembro)	0.54	0.46	0.48	0.54
OptiTROP-Lung05 (sac-TMT+pembro vs pembro)	0.28	0.47	0.44	0.28

Source: WCLC, ASCO, Bernstein analysis

2L+ I/O-TREATED NSCLC

Abstract 2618, IBI363: [Session Detail for Developmental Therapeutics—Immunotherapy](#)

EXHIBIT 3: In 2L+ I/O treated AGA- nsq-NSCLC, IBI363 achieved 17.5m of OS in the lower dose group and 15.2m in the higher dose group, comparable to HS-20093 with better G3 TRAE safety profile

	Science Direct 2026		AACR 2026	ASCO 2026		ASCO 2024		Lancet 2023
Sponsor	Hansoh			Innovent		Daiichi Sankyo / AZ		Akeso
Product	Risvutatur rezetecan (HS-20093)			IBI363		Datopotamab deruxtecan (Dato-DXd)		AK112 (Ivonescimab)
Target & Modality	B7-H3 ADC			PD-1/IL-2 BsAb		TROP2 ADC		PD-1/VEGF BsAb
Trial No.	ARTEMIS-001, NCT05276609		ARTEMIS-101, NCT06332170	CIBI363A102, NCT05460767		TROPION-Lung01, NCT04656652		NCT04736823
Trial location	China		China	China		Global		China
Phase	I		I	I		III		II
Therapy type	2L+		2L+	2L+		2L+		2L+
Indication	IO-treated nsq-NSCLC (without AGA)							
Prior lines of treatments	Median 2 LoT (95.2% platinum-based therapy & 83.2% I/O therapy)		All pts received ≥ 1 LoT (100% platinum-based therapy & 75% I/O therapy)	72.1% ≥ 2 LoT		91.2% ≤ 2 LoT		30% ≥ 2 LoT
Efficacy evaluable pts	67		34	55		370		13
Intervention, n	8.0 mg/kg	10.0 mg/kg	HS-20093 8.0 mg/kg + adefbre 20 mg/kg	0.6/1/1.5 mg/kg	3 mg/kg	Dato-Dxd	Docetaxel	Ivonescimab + docetaxel 75 mg/m2
cORR %	33.3%	10.7%	47.1%	13.8%	24.0%	29.6%	14.1%	30.8%
DCR %	82.1%	67.9%	94.1%	62.1%	76.0%	76.9%	65.8%	61.5%
DoR (months)	7.2	15.3		21.3		8.3	5.6	not reached
mPFS (months)	7.0	4.1	11.2	2.7	4.2 (↓1.4)	5.1	4.0	
PFS HR						0.71		
mOS (months)	Not reached	17.5		17.5	15.2	13.6	12.3	
OS HR						0.9		
Smoking status mOS				Smoker vs non-smoker: 23.4 vs 11.5				
12 month OS rate %	66.4%	52.0%		58.2%	71.6%			
24 month OS rate %				40.2%	42.7%			
Safety profile (ITT)	Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 51.6% (8mg/kg) Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 74.3% (10mg/kg)			Grade ≥3 TEAEs: 48.5% (13.1%); Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 30.3% ^a		Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 25.6% (Dato-Dxd) Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 42.1% (Docetaxel)		Grade ≥3 TEAE: 51.8%; Grade ≥3 TRAE: 26.5%

Note: a. Safety profile shown as grouped data for sq-NSCLC and nsq-NSCLC; updates are highlighted in light blue

Source: Company disclosure, ASCO, Lancet, ScienceDirect, ClinicalTrials.gov, PubMed, Pharmcube, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: In 2L+ I/O treated sq-NSCLC, IBI363 beats with 18.2m of mOS

	Science Direct 2026		ESMO 2023	ASCO 2026		ASCO 2024		Lancet 2023
Sponsor	Hansoh		Daiichi Sankyo	Innovent		Daiichi Sankyo / AZ		Akeso
Product	Risvutatug rezetecan (HS-20093)		Ifinatamab deruxtecان (I-DXd)	IBI363		Datopotamab deruxtecان (Dato-DXd)		AK112 (Ivonescimab)
Target & Modality	B7-H3 ADC		B7-H3 ADC	PD-1/IL-2 BsAb		TROP2 ADC		PD-1/VEGF BsAb
Trial No.	ARTEMIS-001, NCT05276609		NCT04145622	CIBI363A102, NCT05460767		TROPION-Lung01, NCT04656652		NCT04736823
Trial location	China		U.S. & JP	China		Global		China
Phase	Ia/Ib		I/II	I		III		II
Therapy type	2L+		2L+	2L+		2L+		2L+
Indication	IO-treated sq-NSCLC							
Prior lines of treatments (ITT)	Median 2 LoT (95.2% platinum-based therapy & 83.2% I/O therapy)		Median 3 LoT	72.1% ≥ 2 LoT		91.2% ≤ 2 LoT		30% ≥ 2 LoT
Intervention	8.0 mg/kg	10.0 mg/kg	4.8 to 16.0 mg/kg	1/1.5 mg/kg	3 mg/kg	Dato-Dxd	Docetaxel	Ivonescimab + docetaxel 75 mg/m ²
Efficacy evaluable pts	32	26	13	28	31	65	71	7
cORR %	15.6%	26.9%	30.8%	25.9%	36.7%	9.2%	12.7%	57.1%
DCR %	81.3%	76.9%		66.7%	90.0%	66.2%	77.5%	85.7%
DoR (months)	Not reached	7.0	4.1	10.3		5.9	8.1	Not reached
mPFS (months)	4.1	5.7	Not reached	5.5	10.1 (↑0.8)	2.8	3.9	
PFS HR						1.4		
mOS (months)	8.8	Not reached		12.5 (↓2.8)	18.2	7.6	9.4	
OS HR						1.3		
12 month OS rate %	38.7%	74.3%		58.2%	70.9%			
24 month OS rate %				29.9%	47.8%			
Safety profile (ITT)	Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 51.6%	Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 74.3%		Grade ≥3 TEAEs: 48.5% (↑3.1%); Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 30.3% ^a		Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 25.6%	Grade ≥3 TRAEs: 42.1%	Grade ≥3 TEAE: 51.8%; Grade ≥3 TRAE: 26.5%

Note: a. Safety profile shown as grouped data for sq-NSCLC and nsq-NSCLC; updates are highlighted in light blue

Source: Company disclosure, ASCO, ESMO, Lancet, ScienceDirect, ClinicalTrials.gov, PubMed, Pharmcube, Bernstein analysis

1L PD-L1 ALL-COMER NSCLC

Abstract 8586: IBI363 [Session Detail for Lung Cancer—Non-Small Cell Metastatic](#)

Abstract 8513: Punitamig ROSETTA Lung-02 [Session Detail for Lung Cancer—Non-Small Cell Metastatic](#)

Abstract 8527: SHR-A2102 [Session Detail for Lung Cancer—Non-Small Cell Metastatic](#)

EXHIBIT 5: In 1L PD-L1 all comer NSCLC settings, Innovent's IBI363 + chemo combo demonstrates the highest ORR in both sq and nsq-NSCLC vs. peers

	PD-(L)1 mAb				PD-(L)1 BsAb							ADC			
	Pembrolizumab				IBI363				Pumitamig			SHR-A2102			
Sponsor	Merck		Merck		Innovent				BioNTech			Hengrui			
Trial	KEYNOTE-407		KEYNOTE-189, NCT02578680		NCT06468098				ROSETTA Lung-02, NCT06712316			NCT06512051			
Target modality	PD-1 mAb		PD-1 mAb		PD-1 × IL-2 ^{2-bias} BsAb fusion protein				PD-L1 × VEGF-A BsAb			Nectin 4 ADC			
LoT	1L		1L		1L				1L			1L			
Histology	sq-NSCLC		nsq-NSCLC		advanced NSCLC				advanced NSCLC			advanced NSCLC			
Intervention (arm)	Pembro + chemo	PBO + chemo	Pembro + chemo	PBO + chemo	IBI363 + PDC				pumitamig + chemo			SHR-A2102 + adebreli ^m ab			
Efficacy evaluable pts	278	281	410	206	62				40			59			
Subgroups, n	ITT	ITT	ITT	ITT	3-1.5 mg/kg ² , n=22			1.5 mg/kg, n=19	3 mg/kg, n=21	ITT, n=40	sq, n=19	nsq, n=21	ITT, n=59	sq, n=26	nsq, n=33
					ITT	sq, n=14	nsq, n=8	ITT	ITT						
ORR%	62.6%	38.4%	48.0% ¹	19.4% ¹	81.8% ¹	85.7%	87.5%	42.1% ¹	57.1% ¹	52.5% ¹	73.7%	66.7%	74.6%	80.8%	69.7%
mPFS	8	5.1	9.0	4.9	Immature (events 28.8%)										
PFS HR	0.57		0.48												
mOS	17.1	9.1 (adj.) 11.6 (unadj.)	22.0	10.7											
OS HR	0.59		0.56												
Safety	G≥3 TRAE: 56.5%	G≥3 TRAE: 55.7%	G≥3 AE: 71.9%	G≥3 AE: 66.8%	G≥3 TEAE: 65.2%			G≥3 TEAE: 82.1%	G≥3 TEAE: 93.1%	G≥3 TRAE: 44.2%			G≥3 TRAE: 53.7%		

Note: 1. Confirmed ORR; 2. 3-1.5mg/kg represents IBI363 3 mg/kg plus PDC in cycle 1, then 1.5 mg/kg Q3W plus PDC in subsequent cycles

Source: ASCO, NEJM, ClinicalTrials.gov, Bernstein analysis

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